Quantitative Empirical Methods Grad Course Offerings and Subfield Requirements (Updated August 2025)

Core Courses

PLSC 5000a. Foundations of Statistical Inference. P. Aronow, Melody Huang
PLSC 5030b. Causal Inference. P. Aronow, Melody Huang
PLSC 5360a. Applied Quantitative Research Design. Shiro Kuriwaki

Elective Courses

PLSC 5080a. Causal Inference and Research Design. P. Aronow.
PLSC 5110b. Applied Machine Learning and Causal Inference Research Seminar. Jasjeet Sekhon
PLSC 5240a. YData: Data Science for Political Campaigns. Josh Kalla
PLSC 5300a. Data Exploration and Analysis. Ethan Meyers

Workshops

MacMillan-CSAP Workshop on Quantitative Research Methods. P. Aronow and Josh Kalla

Notes:
-a courses are offered in the Fall, b courses are offered in the Spring. ab courses are offered in the Fall and Spring. a/b courses are offered in the Fall or Spring.
-BA/MA students may certify in quant methods by taking 5360 and one of the electives, verifying that they have the prerequisites for taking this elective.
- To those with strong interest in quantitative methods and prior coursework, we recommend taking PLSC 5000 (Fall) and PLSC 5030 (Spring) in the first year. This is the department's main QEM sequence. You should take both classes as a set; taking 5000 alone is not as useful. Similarly, the materials in 5000 are a prerequisite for 5030.
- For students who want to advance their understanding of research design in applied papers and advance their coding skills, we recommend PLSC 5360 (Fall). This is taught at the advanced Masters level.
- Taking both 5000 and 5360 is an option we also recommend considering, either spread out during your first and second years or, less commonly, both in the first year. For those who are underprepared for (or not certain about) PLSC 5000 in their first semester but want solid quantitative methods training, we recommend taking PLSC 5360 in their first fall and 5000 and 5030 in their second year.
-5240and 5300 are suitable for the field requirement for the MA program, but not for the Ph.D. program.

Subfield Requirements

Students may qualify in Quantitative Empirical Methods by exam. To do so, students must first take 5000, and 5030. An advanced doctoral course on research design (e.g., 5080, 5110, S&DS 5170) is also strongly recommended prior to taking the exam. The reading list contains further details and recommendations.